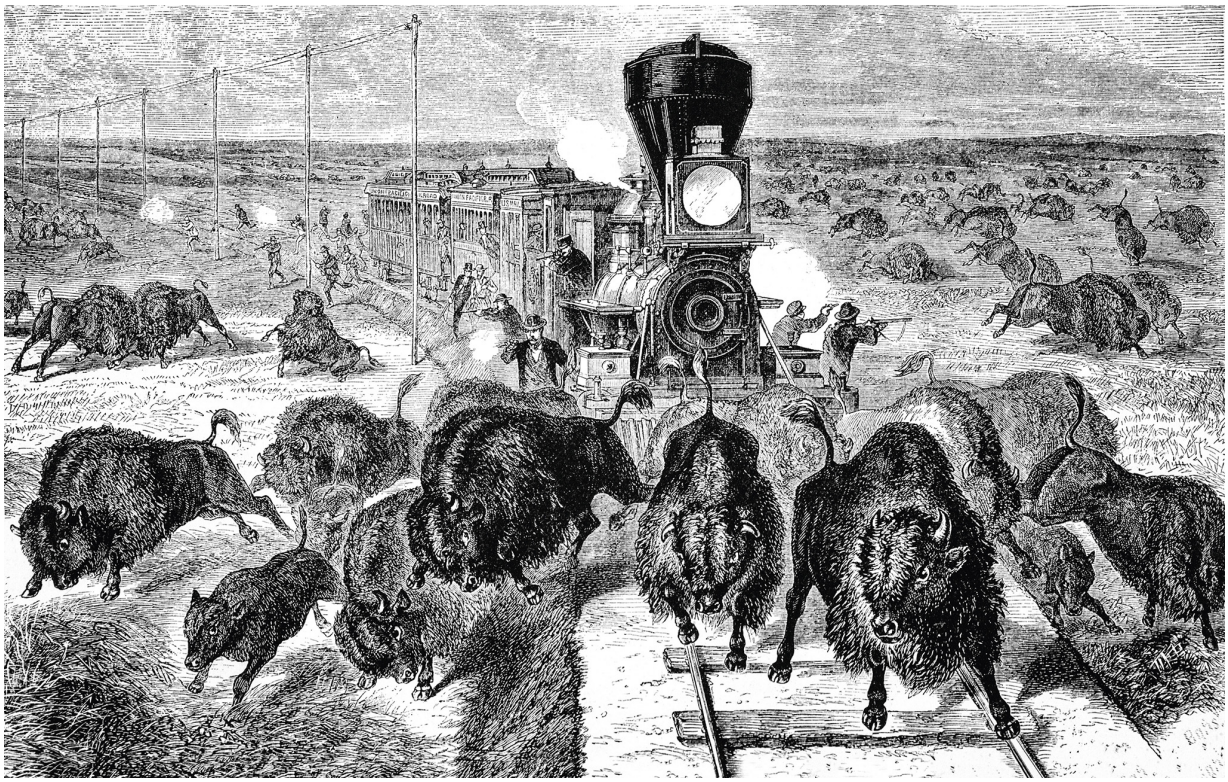


The building of railroads across the US was accompanied by hunters hired to decimate the buffalo population that had sustained Native American tribes. By the end of the 19th century, only a small number of wild buffalo survived.